

- Review your saving amount every few months, to make sure it's still the right amount. You could also review it any time your circumstances change, such as if you get a pay rise, or if you lose out on income.

Complete all of these steps and, ta-da! You're now a saver!

Staying on top of debt

Credit and debt are, in themselves, nothing to be afraid of, but keeping debt under control is vital for your financial wellbeing. My experience with out-of-control debt made a positive relationship with money feel completely out of reach, especially as I had no savings or financial safety net. Having problem debt – which we can loosely define as debt that is affecting your mental health, or where the repayments are really affecting your ability to manage day-to-day and month-to-month – can make you feel like you're constantly on the back foot, or treading water with no hope of actually being able to swim in the direction that you want to go. If at all possible, this type of debt is probably best avoided altogether, but please be reassured that even if you do have significant debt, it's entirely possible to pay it back and start building something in the other direction, whether through budgeting and patience or, if you're struggling to make repayments, with the help of a debt organization.